

Dance for Every Body

Dance for All Abilities



10.5.2025
National Dance Educators Organization
Annual Conference

PRESENTATOR: Tiffany Tindall
Woodland High School Dance Director/Fine Arts Department Lead

What do these students have in common?





Tiffany Tindall, Ed.S.

Dance Director/Fine Arts Dept. Lead
Woodland High School



CAN CONNECTED
ARTS
NETWORKS



NATIONAL
ART EDUCATION
ASSOCIATION



National Association
for Music Education



National Dance Education Organization
Advancing the Quality of Education in the Arts



Educational
Theatre
Association

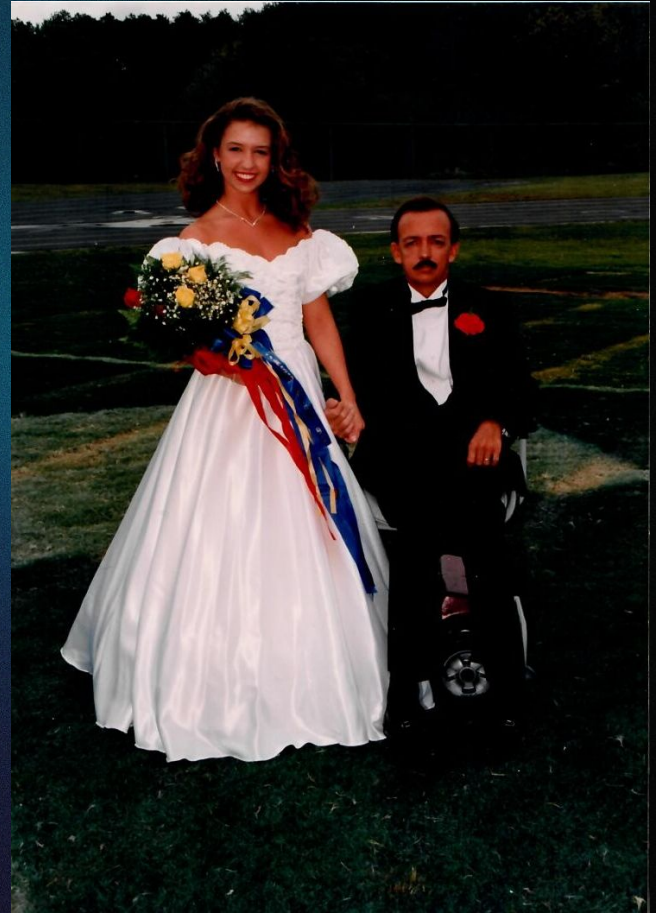


My Family



My Dad and I:

Growing Up with a
Unique Perspective



Karina's Class - The Beginning



Diverse Population Student Engagement



Coming up

1. Strategies you can use
2. What does my program look like
3. What are key benefits
4. How can you get started?



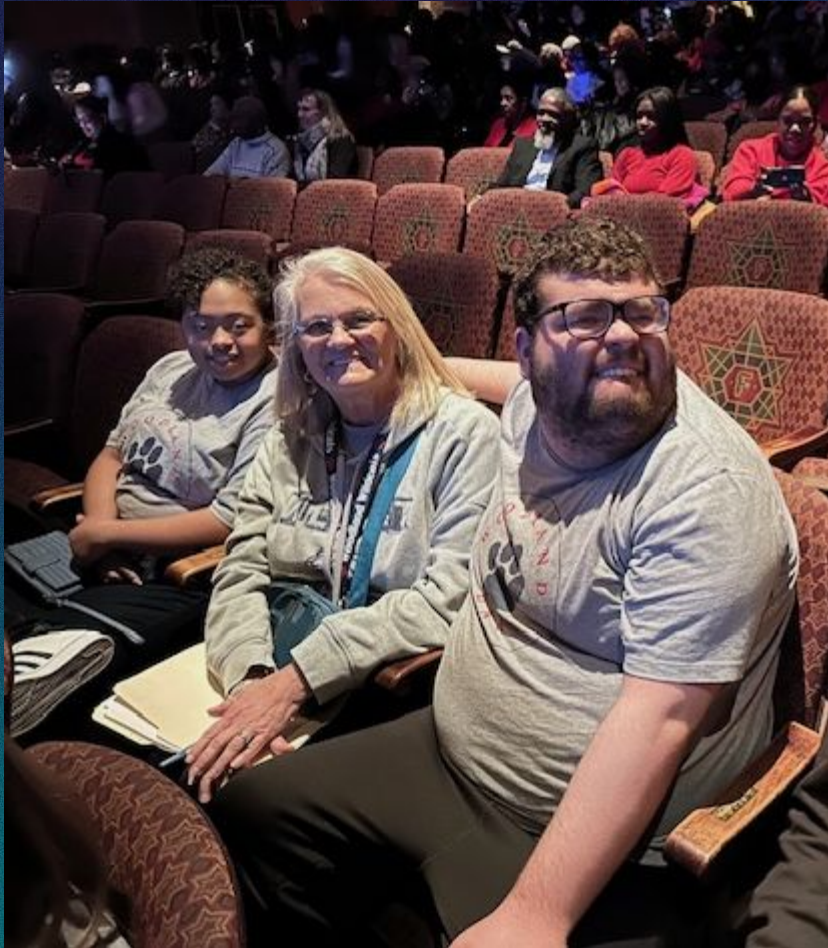
Three Strategies for Success

1. Accommodate the student, not the disability
2. Leverage existing resources
3. Embrace Social Emotional Learning



Strategy 1:
Accommodate
for the student,
not the diagnosis.





Our friend, Eric, with Ms.
Rogers...

Enjoying the field trip
life!

Accommodate for the student, not the diagnosis.

- Strengthens all students
- Breaks down societal biases
- Develops relational skills
- Boosts confidence
- Immersive Least Restrictive Environment
EVERY BODY TOGETHER

Hand Clap



Strategy 2: Leverage existing resources



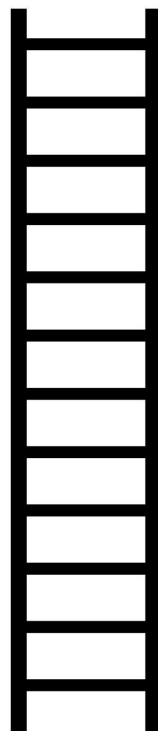
Lean on student's network:



Learning Ladders

Steps to Success!

DANCE ETIQUETTE LADDER



- ___8. STUDENT PUTS ON SHOES AND EXITS ROOM APPROPRIATELY
- ___7. STUDENT DISPLAYS FRIENDLY BEHAVIOR
- ___6. STUDENT CROSSES THE FLOOR WHEN IT IS THEIR TURN
- ___5. STUDENT PARTICIPATES IN CLASS ACTIVITIES AND TRANSITIONS
- ___4. STUDENT ASKS APPROPRIATE QUESTIONS
- ___3. STUDENT PARTICIPATES IN WARM-UP
- ___2. TAKES SHOES AND BELONGINGS AND STORES THEM NEAR THE DOOR
- ___1. ENTER ROOM AND GREET APPROPRIATELY

Leverage Existing Resources:

- Learn new strategies.
- Foster teamwork.
- Enables consistency.
- Fosters increased support

Strategy 3: Embrace Social Emotional Learning



Social Emotional Learning Activities

Somatic Exercises - Somatic Movement, Embodying Rhythms

Reflection Exercises - Oral or Written Reflections on Class Activities

Improviseational Exercises - Mirroring, Sit/Stand/Walk/Run/Relate

Creative Group Work - Choreography Projects, Movement Sentences

Embrace Social Emotional Learning:

- Increased self/social awareness
- Increased confidence
- Increased sense of belonging
- Empathic Learning
- Facilitation of Leadership

WHS Dance Program Structure



What do we do in class?

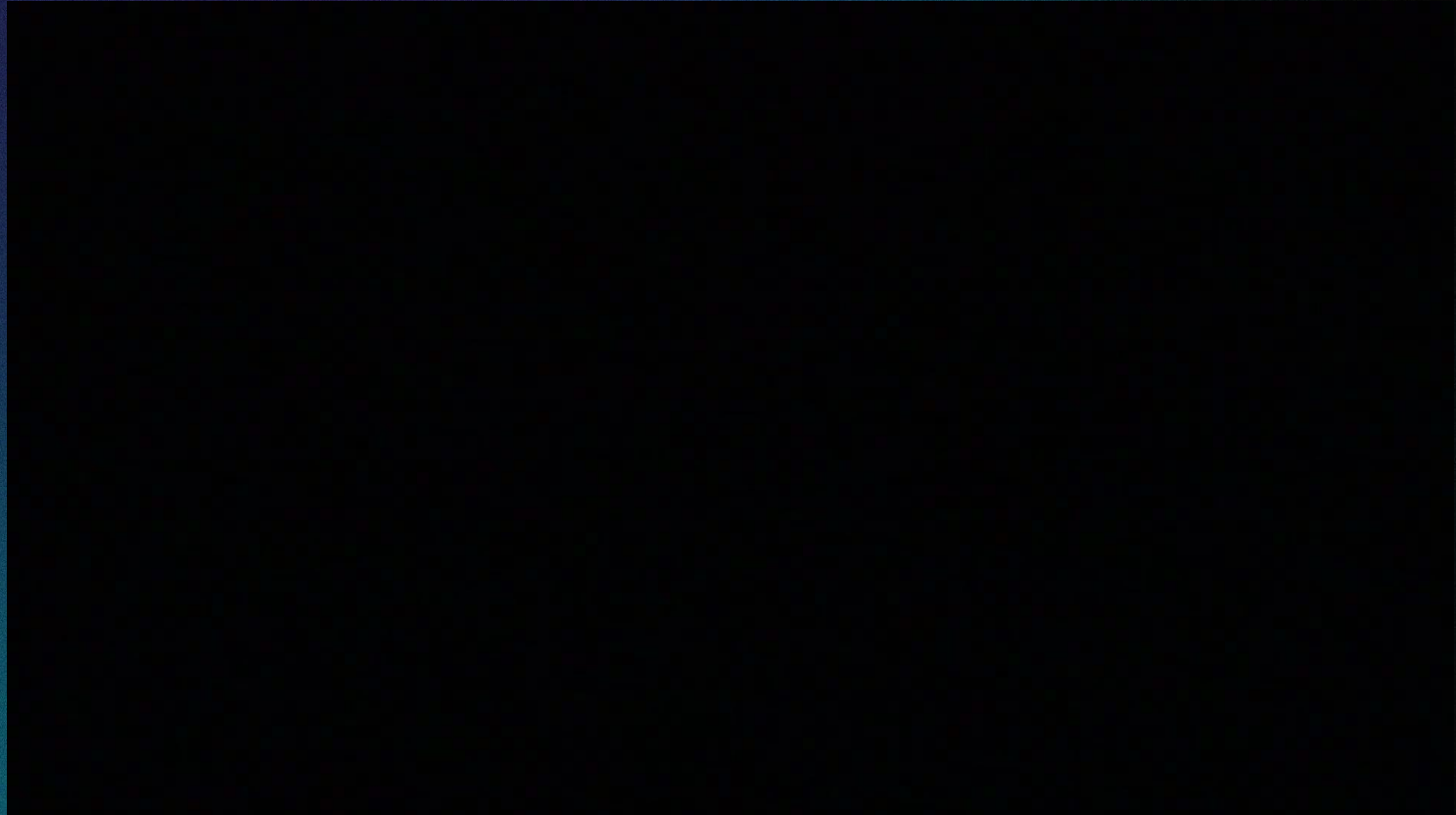
Monday:	Ballet Technique
Tuesday:	Jazz Technique
Wednesday:	Ballet Technique
Thursday:	Jazz Technique
Friday:	Improvisation and Creative Dance

Exercise/Conditioning every day

Beginning Level



Choreography Project



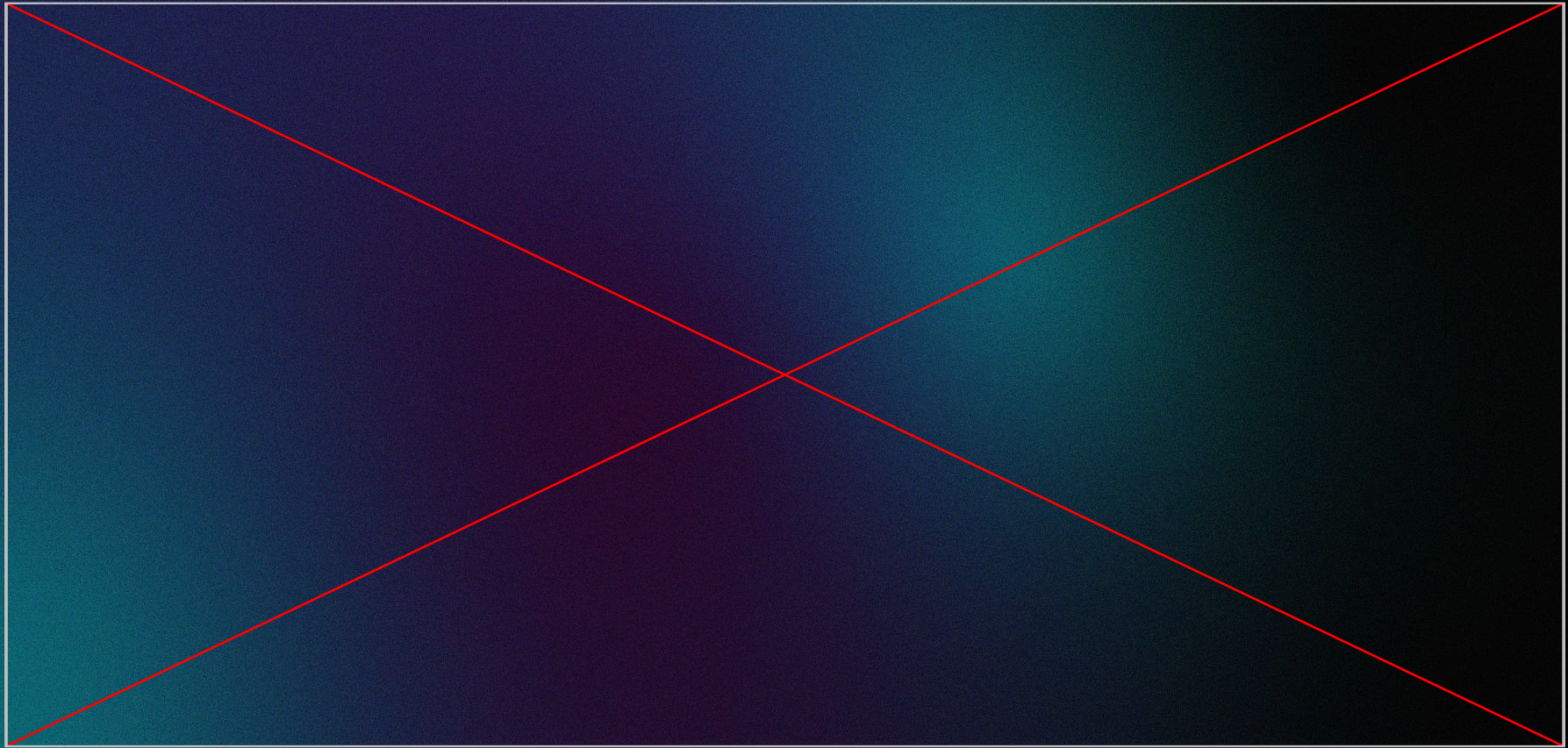
Intermediate Level



Advanced Level



Dance Concert Finale



THANK YOU

Connect with Me
for
Additional Resources



Benefits of Inclusive Dance Classes

For

Students with Disabilities

1. Physical Fitness
2. Independence in Class
3. Social Awareness and Adaptability
4. Social Engagement & Friendships
5. Confidence
6. Love of Dance

Benefits of Inclusive Dance Classes

For

General Education
Students

1. Physical Fitness
2. Social Awareness and Adaptability
3. Social Engagement and Friendships
4. Leadership Opportunities
5. Confidence
6. Love of Dance

Benefits of Inclusive Dance Classes

For
Dance Educators

1. Facilitate improved physical fitness/health of all students.
2. Facilitation of Personal and Social Awareness and Growth.
3. Increased support from Administration and other Faculty.
4. District Office Support and Commendation.

Benefits of Inclusive Dance Classes

For

Special Education
Faculty/Departments

1. Another teacher on their Team.
2. A break or planning time for Special Education teachers.
3. Additional Support for Paraprofessionals.
4. Physical exercise and positive interactions for paraprofessionals and special education staff.